

EXPERIMENT

**I gave two AI
coding tools the
exact same prompt.**

Here's what happened.

THE PROMPT

"Build a single-page web app that's a fortune cookie. Clean, minimal design. You click the cookie and it cracks open with a satisfying animation to reveal an absurd fortune that's loosely inspired by real current news headlines."

Both tools received this identical prompt.
Same user. Same follow-ups. Same requests.

Then I asked both to: deploy to Vercel, add news links to the fortunes, and fix issues.

THE SCOREBOARD

Claude Code

Codex

USER PROMPTS

4

~17

SCREENSHOTS TAKEN

13

0

VERCEL DEPLOYS

3

6

30 bespoke fortunes

25 + live templates

CLAUDE CODE

4 messages. All feature requests.

1

"Build the app"

Searched headlines, wrote the full app, spun up a local server, tested 13 times, fixed 6 layout bugs -- all before I saw anything.

2

"Deploy to Vercel"

One command. Worked immediately.

3

"Add news links"

Restructured all 30 fortunes with headline text and article URLs.
Redeployed.

4

"Links are generic"

Ran 16 web searches to find specific article URLs for every fortune.
Updated all 30.

I only made creative decisions. I never debugged.

CODEx

~17 messages. Mostly bug reports.

1

"Build the app"

Built quickly. Deployed. But the cookie didn't look like a cookie.

2

Bug cascade

Live RSS feeds broke. Cookie became unclickable. CSS overlay, aspect-ratio collapse -- 3 deploys to fix.

3

JS crash

Regex error broke the entire script. I had to screenshot the console error for it to find the bug.

4

Content issues

Murder headlines surfacing as fortunes. Had to add content filters and rewrite templates.

I became the QA team.

THE BIGGEST DIFFERENCE

Self-testing.

CLAUDE CODE

13 screenshots

Opened a browser, clicked the cookie, watched animations, tested reset -- all autonomously. Every bug was caught before I saw the app.

CODEx

0 screenshots

"I can't remotely click-test the deployed page from here." Every bug was discovered by me. I was the unpaid QA engineer.

**Same prompt.
Same human.
Very different
experience.**

*The tool that tests its own work
ships a better product --
and respects your time.*

Full writeup in the comments